

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 9 · UNUSUAL LIVES

Reading

B1+/B2

The Family Who Left the Grid · The Keeper of the Last Light

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think it means to 'leave the grid'?
2. What do you imagine would be the hardest part of producing your own food and electricity?

The Family Who Left the Grid

- 1 Six years ago, Aylin and her husband sold their flat in the city, bought four hectares of rocky hillside, and moved into a tent while they built a house with their own hands. If they hadn't made that decision, they would still be commuting two hours a day and paying rent they could barely afford. Today they grow almost all of their own vegetables, keep chickens and goats, and generate their own electricity from a small solar array on the roof.
- 2 Life off-grid is not simply a romantic escape, however. Aylin describes the first winter as brutal: pipes froze, the solar panels produced almost no power on cloudy days, and there were weeks when the nearest working shop felt impossibly far away. 'We had to become resourceful fast,' she says. 'If we hadn't learned to fix things ourselves, we wouldn't have survived that winter.' Slowly, through trial and error, the family adapted.
- 3 What surprises visitors most is not the hardship but how ordinary the family's days now feel. Aylin no longer misses her old commute, and her children, who grew up thinking every home has running water on tap, now understand exactly where their food and power come from. 'People ask if we regret it,' she says. 'Honestly, if we hadn't taken the risk, I don't think we'd be half as happy as we are now.'

226 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- What is the main idea of the text?
 - Off-grid living is easy and has no real difficulties.
 - A family's decision to live off-grid was hard at times but has ultimately made them happier and more self-sufficient.
 - The family regrets leaving the city and plans to move back.
- The family bought four hectares of hillside and lived in a _____ while they built their house.
- According to the text, what was especially difficult during the first winter?
 - The children refused to help with the animals.
 - Pipes froze and the solar panels produced little power.
 - The local council tried to stop them building.
- According to the text, Aylin says the family regrets taking the risk of moving off-grid.

☐ Correct
 ☐ Incorrect
- Aylin's children now understand exactly where their food and _____ come from.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

- Do you think you could adapt to a life like Aylin's? Why or why not?

- What would you miss most if you moved somewhere completely off-grid?

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

- What do you already know about the job of a lighthouse keeper?

- Do you think isolated jobs like this still exist today? Where?

The Keeper of the Last Light

- On a narrow rock eighteen kilometres from the nearest coastline stands a lighthouse where Meltem has spent every summer for the past nine years. She is one of the very few keepers left whose job

hasn't been fully replaced by automatic lights and remote sensors. For four months at a time, her only regular company is the sound of the wind, the occasional passing ship, and a radio link to the mainland.

- 2 The work itself is precise and demanding: checking the lamp mechanism, logging weather conditions, and keeping meticulous records that shipping companies still rely on. 'People imagine I just sit and read novels all day,' Meltem laughs, 'but a lighthouse that isn't properly maintained is a lighthouse that eventually fails — and ships depend on that light.' Supplies arrive by boat once a fortnight, weather permitting; when storms close in, they simply don't arrive.
- 3 What keeps Meltem returning each year is not tradition alone. She describes a quality of attention that isolated life demands — noticing the smallest change in the sky, the tide, the sound of the generator — that she has never found anywhere else. 'In the city, I moved through my days without really seeing them,' she explains. 'Out here, on a rock where almost nothing changes quickly, I finally learned to pay attention.'

218 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is unusual about Meltem's job, according to the text?
 - ☐ a She is one of the few remaining lighthouse keepers whose job hasn't been fully automated.
 - ☐ b She only works one week a year.
 - ☐ c She shares the lighthouse with dozens of other keepers.
2. Meltem's lighthouse stands on a narrow rock _____ kilometres from the coastline.
3. According to the text, Meltem says her job mainly involves sitting and reading novels.

☐ Correct
 ☐ Incorrect
4. How often do supplies normally arrive at the lighthouse?

☐ a Every day
 ☐ b Once a fortnight, weather permitting
 ☐ c Only once a year
5. Meltem says that on the rock, she finally learned to pay _____.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. Why do you think Meltem keeps returning to such an isolated job every year?

2. Would you be able to cope with four months of near-total isolation? Why or why not?

